

Chapter 13 — Licensing and ethical considerations

Openness is not unlimited

Learning objectives

- By the end of this part

Licenses and the privacy trade-off

- Responsible open science depends on clear licenses and ethical constraints
- Some teams draft custom or restricted licenses that limit redistribution
- Privacy principles and techniques are developed in Chapter 3
- An unrestricted open license signals broad reuse and is appropriate only after privacy

Example 13.26 — Restricted Licenses for Health Data

- Example 13.26 — hands-on module
- Example 13.26 illustrates restricted licensing for sensitive health data
- Use may be limited to qualified researchers or specific contexts such as academic or
- Even de-identified data may remain re-identifiable when combined with other releases
- Explore the chapter example module
- View files: ``modules/chapter13/example26/``

Ethical obligations after sharing

- Ethical principles for collection and privacy are covered in Chapter 3
- Open science adds obligations that arise from making data public
- Researchers should document scope and limitations
- Consent obtained during collection must also cover the intended public release

Example 13.27 — Avoid Reinforcing Bias with Open Data

- Example 13.27 — hands-on module
- Ethical concerns do not end when data are shared; they extend to reuse
- Example 13.27 warns against discriminatory reuse of hiring or healthcare datasets
- Such data should not be used to reinforce biases or perpetuate systemic inequalities
- If data reveal disparities
- View files: ``modules/chapter13/example27/``

Example 13.28 — Indigenous Control Over Shared Data

- Example 13.28 — hands-on module
- Open science must respect the rights and wishes of people and communities whose data are
- Communities involved in collection
- Example 13.28 emphasizes that indigenous communities involved in ecological or
- Explore the chapter example module
- View files: ``modules/chapter13/example28/``

Takeaways

- Licenses can be open or restricted; health data often need limited-access terms
- License choice must follow a privacy assessment, not precede it
- Open release creates ongoing ethical duties around bias, security, attribution, and scope
- Including indigenous communities, retain legitimate control over sharing decisions
- Openness without ethics and privacy is not responsible open science

Next

- Complete the quiz for this part
- The next part covers reproducible research workflows